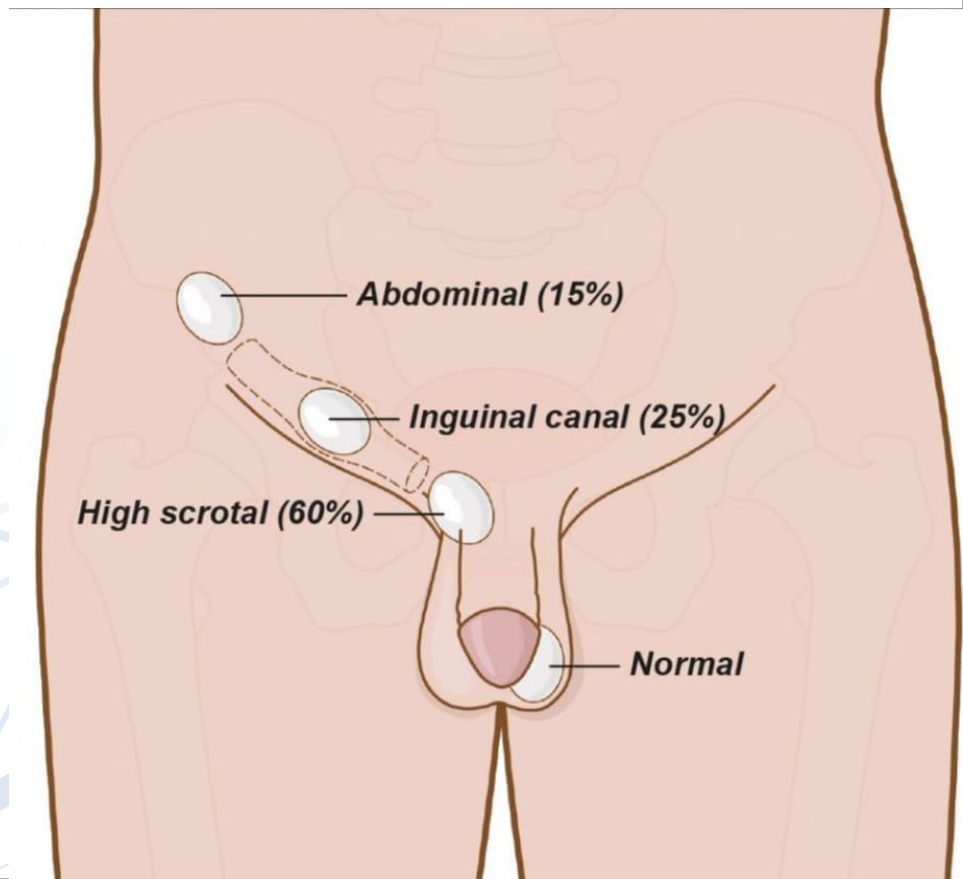
Congenital anomalies of descent of the testis

ALEXANDRIA NATIONAL UNIVERSITY
ANU MEDICAL SCHOOL PROGRAM

1- Undescended testis (Cryptorchidism)

- One or both testes cannot reach the scrotum. The testis lies in the line of its normal descent (abdomen, inguinal canal).

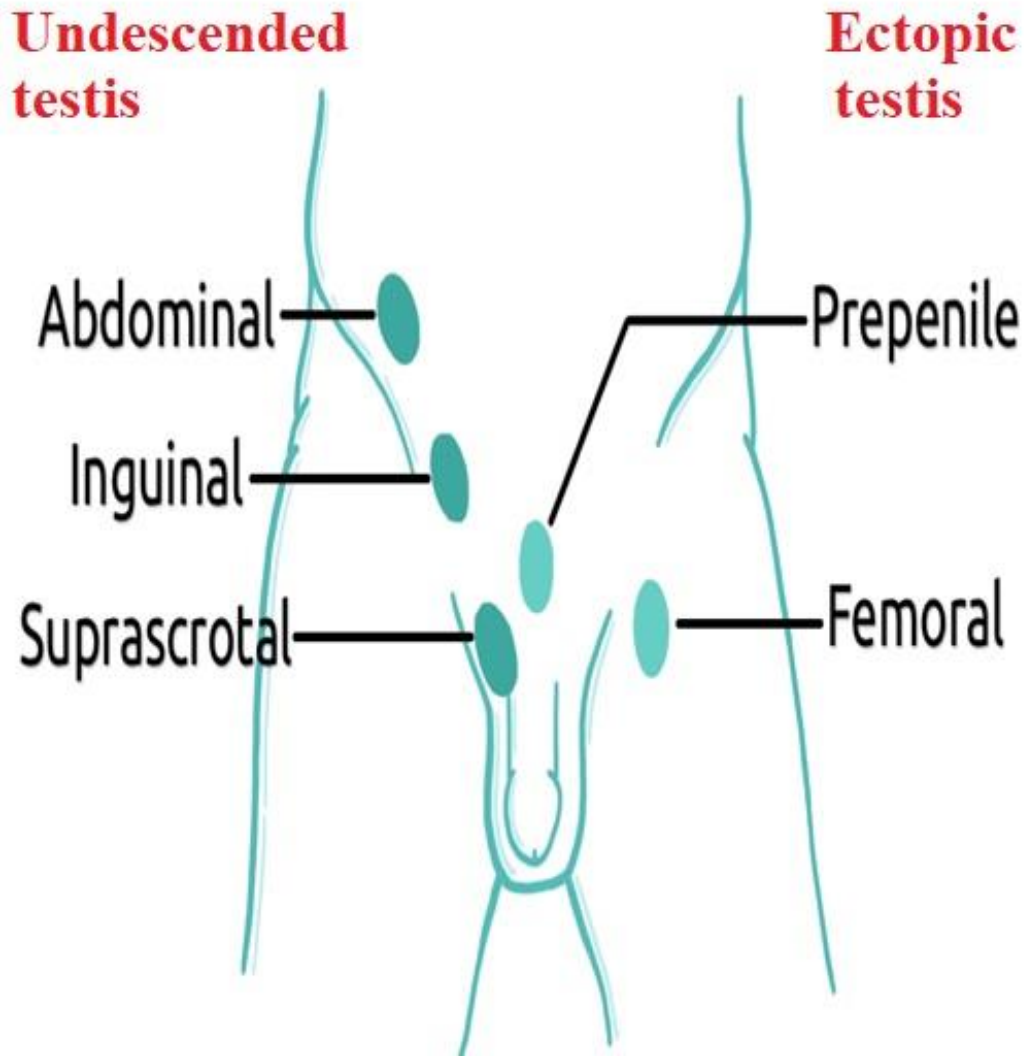
- The undescended testes are unable to produce mature sperms (due to high temperature in the abdominal cavity).



2- Ectopic testis

- The testis lies in a position away from its normal pathway of its descent, such as the penis, perineum or thigh. This is due to abnormal attachment of the gubernaculum testis.

- It can produce sperms as it lies outside the abdomen.



3- Patent processus vaginalis

- The processus vaginalis remains connected with the peritoneal cavity giving :

a. Congenital inguinal hernia: a loop of intestine may herniate through it into the scrotum.



b. Congenital hydrocele: the abdominal opening of the processus vaginalis is small and does not permit a loop of intestine, a peritoneal fluid passes into the patent processus vaginalis forming a scrotal swelling filled with fluid.

